

Empirical Diagnostic Research Report: MP Teacher Professional Development (CPD EDS)

Evidence-Based Findings from 60 Study Teachers across 36 Districts in Madhya Pradesh

1. Executive Summary & Diagnostic Synthesis

This empirical research report presents a rigorous, evidence-based diagnostic evaluation of the **Continuous Professional Development Ecosystem Diagnostic Study (CPD EDS)** in Madhya Pradesh. Analyzing 60 study teachers across 36 districts, the study investigates actual working realities, non-academic workload burdens, training participation rates, digital learning adoption barriers, resource transfer deficits, and CAC mentoring dynamics.

Core Empirical Highlights:

- **Severe Non-Academic Duty Strain:** 68.3% of teachers spend 25–35% of their working hours on non-academic duties (BLO election work, MDM supervision, SIR data collection, APAR ID, and admissions).
- **High Attendance, Low Transfer:** 93.3% attended In-Person Subject Training and 88.3% attended CLSS, but active classroom application drops to only 20–30%.
- **The Digital Learning Paradox:** 66.7% complete digital courses on paper, but field observers note widespread proxy course completion (using spouse phones) and zero content recall.
- **Margdarshika Storage Deficit:** 91.8% received booklets, but materials remain stored in cupboards rather than used in daily lesson planning.
- **Demand for CAC Co-Teaching:** Teachers explicitly demand CACs to conduct **live model teaching demonstrations** inside multigrade classrooms.

2. Quantitative Profile & TPD Participation Census (N = 60 Teachers)

Training Modality	Participating Teachers	Percentage (%)	Primary Engagement Character
In-Person Subject Training	56 / 60	93.3%	Highest rated format; valued for Think-Pair-Share and peer exchange
CLSS (Shaikshik Samwaad)	53 / 60	88.3%	Valued for cross-school discussions; school-level cascading is informal
Digital Training (DIKSHA/iGOT)	40 / 60	66.7%	Moderate paper completion; high proxy usage and zero recall
YouTube Live (YTL) Follow-ups	21 / 60	35.0%	Moderate engagement; affected by mobile network connectivity
Election / BLO Duties (Non-Academic)	17 / 60	28.3%	Major non-academic burden causing instructional disruption

3. TabFM Machine Learning & Counterfactual Simulation Results

Using Google's Tabular Foundation Model (TabFMRegressor & TabFMClassifier), we simulated 5 TPD policy scenarios predicting classroom lesson plan adoption:

Intervention Scenario	Strategy Description	Predicted Adoption (%)
Baseline	Current Observed System State	16.0%

Scenario A: Full Integrated TPD	Subject Training + Digital Training + CLSS	12.0%
Scenario B: Subject Training Only	Standalone In-Person Subject Workshop	2.7%
Scenario C: Digital Training Only	Standalone DIKSHA / iGOT Online Modules	0.0%
Scenario D: CLSS Only	Standalone Shaikshik Samwaad Discussions	0.0%
Scenario E: Zero Intervention	No TPD Engagement Provided	0.0%

4. Deep Qualitative Findings Grounded in Real Verbatims & Field Notes

Domain 1: Non-Academic Workload Burden & Administrative Disruption

Non-academic duties consume 25–35% of teacher working hours, severely reducing lesson preparation time.

"Student documentations, Attendance, school level data collection (MDM / SIR / Election duty) and update into various platforms and portals." — Teacher Statement
"He is regular in his classroom, but involved 30% in non-academic work also... While sharing responses, teacher shared concern that sometimes competing administrative responsibilities as Head Master make it difficult." — Field Observer Note

Domain 2: In-Person Training Experience & Value Drivers

Teachers value in-person workshops when centered on practical, activity-based methods (Think-Pair-Share). Lecture-heavy presentations without classroom practice are rated low.

"Teacher found the in-person training useful for understanding how to engage with students through activity-based methods. The think-pair-share group activity was highlighted." — Field Observer Note

Domain 3: Pedagogical Material Transfer (Margdarshika Booklets)

Printed materials reach schools, but classroom implementation drops to 20–30% due to student learning gaps and administrative burden.

"Teacher had access to and used the Margdarshika resource; however, its use was occasional... She tried to adopt learning from training, but due to student learning levels and other work, she implements only 20–30% in class." — Field Observer Note

Domain 4: Digital Learning Barriers (DIKSHA & iGOT)

Digital course completion numbers mask a widespread proxy completion phenomenon driven by rural network failures and asynchronous screen fatigue.

"Teacher says he has done courses, but doesn't remember anything major... feels like he either hasn't done it and asked somebody else (proxy)... Completed courses using his wife's phone." — Field Observer Note

Domain 5: Peer Learning Communities (CLSS / Shaikshik Samwaad)

Shaikshik Samwaad (CLSS) fosters positive peer exchange during sessions, but school-level cascading remains informal (tea-time chats) or non-existent in 1-teacher schools.

"CLSS [redacted], [redacted]... — Field Observer Note

Domain 6: Classroom Observation & Mentoring Expectations

Teachers explicitly request CACs to move away from administrative inspection and deliver live demonstration lessons inside multigrade classrooms.

"CAC and mentors should come to school, take a class to demonstrate how to teach multigrade students, and show us practical techniques." — Teacher Demand

5. Actionable Future Measures & Strategic Policy Roadmap

1. Institutional Protection of Instructional Time (0–6 Months)

Issue a strict department order capping non-academic administrative assignments during active terms. Re-allocate BLO voter verification and portal entries to dedicated block data operators.

2. Shift from Standalone Digital to Blended TPD (6–18 Months)

Stop relying on standalone digital courses as primary training mechanisms. Reposition DIKSHA as a supplementary micro-library while keeping core TPD centered on interactive face-to-face workshops.

3. Embed Live Demonstration Lessons in Training (6–18 Months)

Re-design in-person subject training to include live model teaching demonstrations by master trainers showing multigrade classroom management.

4. Transform CAC Roles into Academic Instructional Coaches (0–6 Months)

Re-orient Cluster Academic Coordinators (CACs) from inspection officers to instructional coaches who spend 70% of visit time co-teaching and delivering model lessons.

5. Establish Single-Teacher Peer Collaboration Hubs (18–36 Months)

Create dedicated cluster-level peer network hubs where single-teacher educators meet bi-weekly to share multigrade lesson plans and solve contextual challenges.